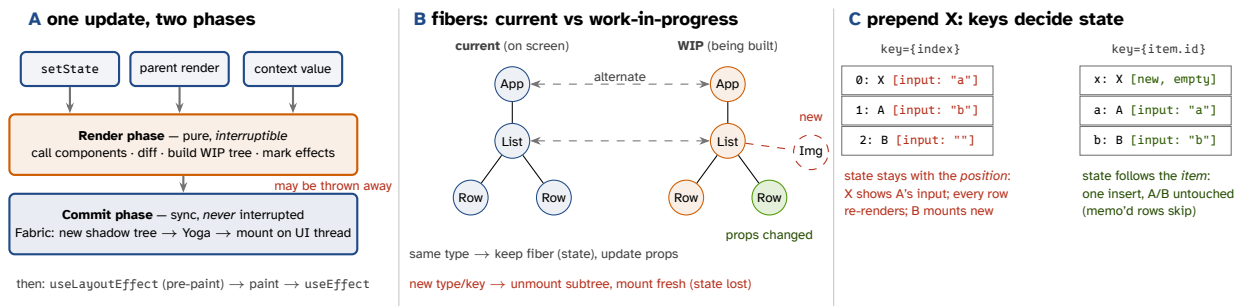


In one line: A render **calls your components** to produce a new element tree; **reconciliation** diffs it against the current **fiber** tree by **type + key**; only the *differences* are **committed** — on RN as a new Fabric shadow tree that is laid out (Yoga) and mounted as native-view mutations. *Re-render* $\neq$ *native update*.



How it works

- Element** = immutable description {type, props, key}, cheap, recreated every render. **Fiber** = the persistent instance record: state, hooks list, effects, links; current + alternate (WIP) double buffer (diagram B).
- Diff heuristics** (O(n), not optimal tree edit): different **type** at a position → destroy + recreate the subtree; same type → reuse, update props; children matched by **key**, else by index.
- Render phase** must be pure — React may run it twice, pause it, or drop it. **Commit** applies mutations atomically, then runs layout effects; passive effects (useEffect) run after paint.
- RN:** React's commit hands Fabric a new *immutable* shadow tree; Fabric diffs it with the mounted one and sends the UI thread only the mutations — like a UICollectionView diffable snapshot.

What re-renders — and what does not

- Yes:** own state set to a *new* value (Object.is); the **parent rendered** (props equal or not — unless React.memo); a consumed **context** value changed; an external store snapshot changed.
- No:** mutating state in place (same reference → bail out: a bug), writing a ref, a global variable. Props never “change on their own”.

Batching & concurrent React on RN

- Automatic batching** (React 18): all setState in one tick (handlers, promises, timeouts) → one render. On RN it needs the **concurrent root = New Architecture**; the legacy root batched only inside React event handlers.
- startTransition / useTransition:** mark an update *non-urgent* — it renders interruptibly, urgent input (typing) wins. **useDeferredValue:** lag a value behind. **Suspense:** show a fallback while a child waits (React.lazy, data via a library or use). Fully supported with Fabric; not on the legacy renderer.
- StrictMode** (dev only): renders twice, initialisers/reducers twice, and *mount* → *unmount* → *mount* for effects — surfaces impure renders and missing cleanups. Production runs once.

Host components & Text rules

- View → UIView, ScrollView → UIScrollView, TextInput → UITextField/UITextView. Layout-only Views are **flattened** away (collapsible={false} keeps one).
- Every string/number must sit inside <Text>. Nested <Text> = spans of *one* attributed string (NSAttributedString) — the only place styles inherit. A View has no font.

Example — identity bugs

```
// BAD index key: prepend -> state shifts rows (diagram C)
{items.map((it, i) => <Row key={i} item={it} />)}
<FlatList data={items} keyExtractor={it => it.id} ... /> // OK
// BAD component defined in render: NEW type every render
function Screen() {
  const Row = () => <TextInput />; // remounts: text+focus lost
  return <Row />; // fix: hoist to module level
}
// BAD on RN: count=0 renders raw "0" outside <Text> -> red box
{count && <Badge n={count} />} // OK: {count > 0 && ...}
<Profile key={userId} /> // new key = deliberate reset
```

Yoga flexbox vs web CSS

	Web	RN (Yoga)
flexDirection	row	column
flexShrink	1	0 (overflow instead)
alignContent	stretch	flex-start
flex	shorthand	one number
units	px, em, rem, vh	unitless dp/pt or %
inheritance	cascade	none — only Text in Text
position	static	relative
box model	content-box	border-box

Traps

- ! “Re-render = slow”: render is JS work; native cost is only the committed diff. Profile before memo.
- ! Index keys only for static, never-reordered lists without row state.
- ! After setState the variable still holds the *old* value — state is a per-render snapshot.

Remember

Type + key = identity. Render proposes, commit disposes.